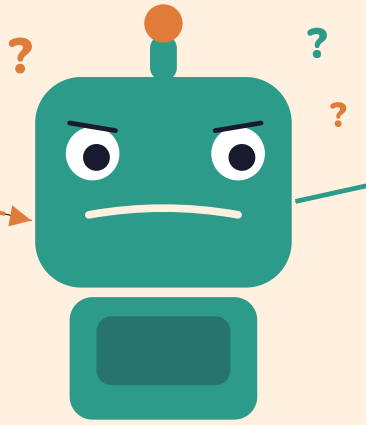
HOW DO YOU TALK TO AI?

Does the way you ask change what you get?

"give me a story"
(vague · no context)

AI OUTPUT
Once upon a time there was a dog. The end.
★☆☆☆☆ Generic!

WEAK PROMPT



"Write 100 words about a lost dog, from the dog's point of view."

AI OUTPUT
The cold rain fell on my fur. Every corner smelled of strangers...
★★★★★ Rich & vivid!

STRONG PROMPT

PROMPT QUALITY = OUTPUT QUALITY

Vague in → Vague out ⟷ Specific in → Rich out

TIP: Add role · context · format · length · audience

PROMPT COMPARE IMPROVE

HOW DO YOU TALK TO AI?

Students often think AI gives the same answer regardless of how they ask. This card shows that prompt quality directly shapes output quality — a skill that transfers to writing, thinking, and communication.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Show two versions of the same request: vague ("Tell me about dogs") vs specific ("Describe the daily routine of a guide dog working in a city, in 100 words"). Read both AI outputs aloud and compare.
2. Students work in pairs to rewrite three vague prompts from the provided list, making them more specific, targeted, and clear.
3. Compare the vague and improved prompts. What changed? What rule can we write together?
4. Create a class "Prompt Rulebook" — 3 to 5 principles for talking to AI well, posted on the wall.

MATERIALS

- Printed vague prompt list (one per pair)
- Whiteboard or shared class doc
- AI tool access (optional — pre-print outputs)
- Sticky notes for Prompt Rulebook
- Coloured pens for annotation

REFLECTION

- What makes a prompt useful?
- Why does context help AI give better answers?
- Could the same skills help you write better emails or essays?
- What is the difference between a question and a good question?

REALITY CHECK

AI does not guess what you mean.

It responds to what you say. A better question almost always produces a better answer. The skills for prompting AI — clarity, context, specificity — are the same skills needed for clear writing and communication.

DIGITAL GAME

Prompt Trainer Game

Scan to play →